FiTEN Business Directory

A Year-Round B2B Platform for Tamil Entrepreneurs

Connecting Tamil Businesses — Across Cities, Across Borders

Presented to	FiTEN Executive Committee
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Version	v1.0 — For Review
Contact	www.fiten.org

THE OPPORTUNITY

FiTEN has spent 40 years building one of the most connected Tamil entrepreneur networks in North America. But that network lives in event halls — not online. When the FiTEN Edison conference ends, the connections made disappear. There is no searchable directory, no persistent profile, no way for a Tamil founder in New Jersey to find a Tamil software agency in Chennai.

The FiTEN Business Directory changes that. It turns the FiTEN network into a year-round platform — searchable, trusted, and built specifically for Tamil B2B commerce.

500K+	100+	1,000+
Tamil Businesses in North America	**FeTNA Sangams across US & Canada**	**Annual FiTEN Event Attendees**
Potential audience	Existing community base	Built-in founding members

WHAT WE'RE BUILDING

A searchable, bilingual (English + Tamil) business directory hosted on fiten.org — with features no general platform offers:

B2B Networking	Founders signal: Open to Partnership / Seeking Investment / Available for Mentorship. Connect directly with Tamil business owners.
Investor-Startup Pipeline	Tamil-founded startups flag funding stage and sector. Tamil VCs and investors filter by stage, geography, and industry to find matches.
Cross-Border Commerce	Bridge US and India. Tamil IT firms in Chennai find US Tamil clients. Tamil founders in New Jersey source Tamil vendors in India.
FiTEN Event Identity	Every FiTEN speaker, exhibitor, and award winner gets a permanent profile. Their event history lives on the directory — not just in a conference programme.
Verified Trust Badge	'Verified FiTEN Member' badge — free for all active members. A trust signal backed by 40 years of FeTNA credibility that no Google star rating can match.
Bilingual (EN + Tamil)	Full English and Tamil-script interface. Tamil-language business descriptions and search serve both diaspora and Tamil Nadu-based businesses.

HOW IT ROLLS OUT

Phase	Timeline	What's Included
Phase 1	**Months 1–3**	English directory: search, business profiles, category browse, admin panel, mobile-optimised. Language toggle with Tamil 'Coming Soon'. Silver listing tier opens.
Phase 2	**Months 4–6**	Full Tamil language, verified badges, B2B connection requests, open-to-partnership signals, FiTEN event profile integration, email digest, Gold tier opens.
Phase 3	**Months 7–9**	Investor-startup matching, co-founder search, analytics dashboard for owners, sponsored placements, Platinum tier opens.
Phase 4	**Month 10+**	AI-powered recommendations, Tamil Nadu government startup registry integration, global Tamil association API access.

THE BUSINESS MODEL

Revenue is phased to match feature delivery — businesses never pay for features that aren't live yet.

Free	Silver $9/mo	Gold $22/mo	Platinum $42/mo
Name & category	Logo & photos	Priority placement	Homepage spotlight
Contact info	Full description	Tamil description	Sponsored result
Member badge	Social links	Email digest	Feature article
	Reviews enabled	Analytics dashboard	Event booth discount

Additional revenue: banner advertising ($300–800/mo per category), event exhibitor bundles ($200/exhibitor), job board ($75/posting), annual Tamil Business Report (Year 2).

	Year 1 (ramp-up)	Year 2 (steady state)
Listing subscriptions	**$8,590**	**$24,540**
Advertising & bundles	**$6,000**	**$14,200**
Job board & reports	**$1,500**	**$10,000**
Total	**~$16,090**	**~$48,740**

WHAT IT COSTS TO BUILD

Phase 1 (Months 1–3)	$8,000–$15,000 contracted / $0–$2,000 volunteer-led. Covers design, front-end, back-end, admin panel, and database.
Phase 2–3 (Months 4–9)	$5,000–$10,000 incremental — Tamil localization, badge system, Stripe payments, analytics dashboard.
Hosting & infrastructure	$50–$150/month (Vercel + PostgreSQL + CDN). Year 1 total: ~$600–$1,800.
Search, email & tools	Algolia + SendGrid: ~$400–$800/year combined at Year 1 volume.
Year 1 total investment	$12,000–$25,000 (contracted) or $3,000–$7,000 (volunteer-led). Covered by Year 1 revenue of ~$16,000.

NEXT STEPS

1. Board approval	FiTEN Executive Committee approves proposal and authorises Phase 1 budget. Target: within 30 days.
2. Appoint Directory Lead	Designate a board member or trusted community leader as project owner.
3. Recruit developers	Open call to FiTEN / FeTNA community. Target: 2–3 volunteer developers committed before any contracting begins.
4. 100 founding listings	Recruit 100 businesses from existing member network before public launch. Incentive: free lifetime Silver tier.
5. Build & soft launch	90-day Phase 1 build. Soft launch at next FiTEN Edison event — live kiosk demo and QR code sign-up.

FiTEN Business Directory

The Tamil entrepreneurial network — made searchable, trusted, and permanent.

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